

Deperdussin Type C

Armand Deperdussin was a colorful entrepreneur who founded the Deperdussin Aviation Company in 1910. The company's aircraft (including the 1911 Type C) were designed by a 30-year-old engineer, Louis Béchereau. A series of advanced monoplanes ensued, which set a number of world speed records. The first in excess of 100mph (162kph) was achieved by Jules Védrines on February 22, 1912. When, in 1913, Deperdussin was jailed for fraud, his company was bought by Louis Blériot, with Béchereau retained as chief designer.

ENGINE 100hp inline

WINGSPAN 28ft 9in (8.8m) **LENGTH** 18ft 6in (5.5m)

TOP SPEED 100mph (162kph) **CREW** 1

PASSENGERS None



Farman (Maurice) 1912 Type Militaire

Although the Farman brothers became joint aircraft manufacturers in 1912, their designs were separate, with Maurice concentrating, from 1909 onward, on improvements to the Voisin concept. It was a Maurice Farman design that was entered by Airco into the 1912 Military Aeroplane Competition, leading to a substantial order from the British Army for training and reconnaissance purposes. This type became known as the "Longhorn" after the extended front landing skids.

ENGINE 80hp Renault

WINGSPAN 50ft 11in (15.5m) **LENGTH** 37ft 10in (11.5m)

TOP SPEED 65mph (105kph) **CREW** 2

PASSENGERS None



Sopwith Tabloid

Although not the first single-seat scout aircraft, the Tabloid was the most successful British racing and scout aircraft prior to WWI. The Tabloid won the Schneider Trophy in 1914 and flew with both the Royal Flying Corps and the Royal Naval Air Service during the war.

ENGINE 80hp Gnome rotary

WINGSPAN 25ft 6in (7.7m) **LENGTH** 20ft 4in (6.2m)

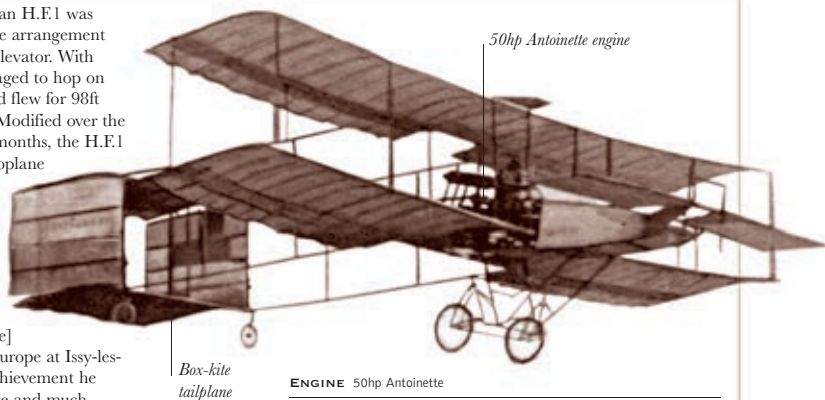
TOP SPEED 92mph (148kph) **CREW** 1

PASSENGERS None



Voisin Henri Farman H.F.1

The Voisin Henri Farman H.F.1 was a biplane with a box-kite arrangement and a forward biplane elevator. With casters wheels, it managed to hop on September 30, 1907 and flew for 98ft (30m) on October 7th. Modified over the course of the next few months, the H.F.1 reappeared with a monoplane forward elevator and covered nacelle, and tail with side curtains. With Henri Farman at the controls, on January 13, 1908, the H.F.1 made the first one-kilometer [0.62-mile] closed-circuit flight in Europe at Issy-les-Moulineaux. For this achievement he won a 50,000-franc prize and much acclaim for the aircraft.



ENGINE 50hp Antoinette

WINGSPAN 35ft 6in (10.8m) **LENGTH** 44ft (13.45m)

TOP SPEED 38mph (60kph) **CREW** 1

PASSENGERS None

Goupy 1909 (II)

Although not particularly successful, the Goupy No.2, together with the Breguet Tractor Biplane, was to establish the standard configuration of all future front-engined biplanes. Designed by Ambroise Goupy and Lieutenant M. Calderara, the machine was built in the Blériot factory and first "hopped" in March 1909. The more successful designs of one of Britain's aviation pioneers, A.V. Roe, were influenced by the Goupy No.2.



ENGINE 25hp REP

WINGSPAN 19ft 8in (6m) **LENGTH** 23ft (7m)

TOP SPEED 69mph (97kph) **CREW** 1

PASSENGERS None

Santos-Dumont Demoiselle

The Santos-Dumont No.19 Demoiselle ("Dragonfly") made its maiden flight in November 1907, but it was the improved No. 20 version which went into commercial production in 1909. The smallest airplane of its time, it was the true ancestor of modern ultralight aircraft, having a bamboo fuselage, a detachable single wing, and a tricycle landing gear. It was also one of the first "home-built" airplanes as Santos-Dumont freely gave the rights to the design. The lightweight 235lb (107kg) Demoiselle – selling for 5,000 francs (\$1,400) – was more popular with the public than with pilots.

ENGINE 25hp 2-cylinder Duthheil-Chalmers

WINGSPAN 16ft 5in (5m) **LENGTH** 19ft 8in (6m)

TOP SPEED 62mph (100kph) **CREW** 1

PASSENGERS None



Wright Type A

At Le Mans, on August 8, 1908, Wilbur Wright flew the Wright Type A in front of an astonished French audience. His obvious and apparently effortless mastery of the air during a brief 1 minute 45 second flight, was to revolutionize European aviation. A month later, on September 3, Orville Wright began a series of tests at Fort Meyer near Washington, DC, which silenced the brothers' American critics. A new era of practical aviation began, as the Type A was built under licence in France, Britain, and Germany, as well as by the Wrights themselves.

ENGINE 30hp 4-cylinder Wright water-cooled inline

WINGSPAN 41ft (12.5m) **LENGTH** 31ft (9.5m)

TOP SPEED 40mph (64kph) **CREW** 1

PASSENGERS None

